THE CLUB

by Molly Baz

Pistachio Halva Rose Granola

MAKES 10 CUPS

I've made a lot of granola in my day, and at times it can feel more like I'm eating a crumbled cookie than I am a bowl of cereal and milk. That's where puffed grains come in. In this recipe, you'll use a 50/50 mix of unsweetened puffed grains and regular old oats. Any puffed grain will do (millet, rice, kamut, etc.), and you can find it in bags in the cereal section of most grocery stores. It lends an airiness and crunch to this very special pistachio and halva-flavored granola. Dried rose petals are optional here, but they are what make this granola feel worthy of being gifted, which is exactly what I hope you'll do with it when you make it. Let it cool entirely, divvy it up into mason jars with a cute label and a bow, and stop wasting money on presents that people don't actually want! Nobody has ever re-gifted a jar of homemade granola, and especially not one that's this delicious, I promise.

ACTIVE TIME: 25 MINS
TOTAL TIME: 1 HR

PANTRY

- ¾ cup (155 grams) packed light or dark brown sugar
- ½ cup olive oil
- 2 tablespoons vanilla extract
- 2 ½ cups (245 grams) old fashioned oats (not quick-cooking)
- 2 ¼ cups (55 grams) puffed rice, puffed millet, or puffed kamut
- ⅓ cup (45 grams) sesame seeds
- Kosher salt
- 6 ounces halva of your choice (I like pistachio or vanilla)
- 8 ounces (about 1 cup) roasted salted pistachios
- ⅓ cup dried rose petals

DAIRY

- 1 large egg white

1. PREP THE OVEN:

- Preheat oven to 325 degrees with racks in the upper and lower thirds and line two rimmed baking sheets with parchment paper.

2. MAKE GRANOLA MIXTURE:

- In a large bowl, whisk 1 egg white until frothy, about 30 seconds. Add ¾ cup packed brown sugar and whisk until thick and viscous, 30 seconds.
- Stream in ½ cup olive oil and 2 tablespoons vanilla and whisk to incorporate.
- Add 2 ½ cups oats, 2 ¼ cups puffed rice/millet/kamut, ⅓ cup sesame seeds, and 2 ½ teaspoons salt. Mix to thoroughly coat with a spatula.

3. BAKE:

- Divide between the prepared baking sheets, spreading into an even layer. Transfer to the oven and bake, rotating from top to bottom and front to back halfway through, until lightly golden, about 20-30 minutes.
- Remove from the oven and crumble 6 ounces halva over the baking sheets.
- Return baking sheets to the oven (switching from top to bottom and bottom to top) and continue to bake, without stirring, until the halva is melted and dry, and a shade darker in color, about 10-20 minutes more. Watch carefully, as you don't want the halva to burn. The sheet tray at the top of the oven may be done sooner than the bottom one; that's okay! Take them each out as they are done.

4. FINISH:

- While the granola bakes, roughly chop 8 ounces roasted salted pistachios.
- Remove the granola from the oven and, while still warm, add in the pistachios and ⅓ cup rose petals, breaking up the roses into petals if they came whole. Toss to combine, gently breaking up the granola but leaving in clusters as much as possible, and let cool completely. Store in airtight containers for up to 2 weeks.

FILED UNDER: BAKING, SWEETS